🔪 Knife Skills: Reading · ANSWER KEY

Culinary 1 · Unit 6 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Knife Skills Etc. (Knife Skills PowerPoint and worksheets)

Name: _____

Knife Skills

A knife has parts. The blade is the cutting part, and the tip and edge are on the blade. The tang is the metal that goes inside the handle. The bolster is the thick part between the blade and the handle. A full tang makes a knife strong and balanced.

Use the right knife for the job. The chef's knife is the most used knife: chop, dice and mince. The serrated knife has teeth for bread and tomatoes. The paring knife is small for peeling and cutting out bad spots. The filet knife is thin and bendy for fish.

A sharp knife is a safe knife, because a dull knife slips. Hold food with the claw grip: tuck your fingertips under, with your knuckles guiding the blade. Never try to catch a falling knife; step back. Carry a knife point down at your side and never leave one in a sink of soapy water.

Basic cuts: dice is even cubes, chop is uneven pieces, mince is the finest cut, julienne is thin matchsticks, batonnet is French-fry sticks and rondelle is round slices.

Blanching means boiling fruits or vegetables quickly, then putting them in ice water to stop the cooking. It sets the color and loosens skins, like on peaches and tomatoes.

Check your reading

1. Why is a sharp knife safer than a dull one?
A dull knife needs more force and slips.
2. What is the claw grip?
Fingertips tucked under, knuckles guide the knife.
3. What are the two steps of blanching?
Boil quickly, then plunge into ice water.